ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	34th Commission Meeting
DATE:	19 August, 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	Druk Dradhir Khang

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSIONS	DECISIONS
1	**Update on Escrow Account for the month of July 2026 – EMD, DoPS** The status of the Escrow Account was updated to the Commission. As against the closing balance of Nu. 33,045,574.36 at the end of June 2026, the closing balance as of July stood at Nu. 21,096,381.15. It was apprised that Nu. 12,523,224.21, related to auction proceeds for case 22/2022, had been transferred to the DRC. Further, it was noted that about 70 individuals associated with the monument cases, had not yet complied with the administrative sanction. *The details are provided in Annexure 1.*	The Commission noted the update.
2	**Propose institution of intra-departmental/ divisional heads coordination forum – Director, DoPS** The Director proposed the institution of an intra-Departmental/Divisional Heads coordination forum to strengthen internal coordination among the Departments and Divisions. The forum intends to provide a platform for discussing cross-cutting issues, addressing coordination gaps, and ensuring better alignment of activities across. It was proposed that the forum will meet quarterly or on an adhoc basis, depending on the need and issues requiring coordination.	The proposal was endorsed. To ensure clarity on the purpose, composition, and functioning of the forum, the Commission directed to adopt a detailed Terms of Reference. In similar lines, DoPS, PPD, and all Departments/Divisions were directed to explore opportunities for greater engagement in cross-departmental activities. In particular, encouraged to participate in the NIA dissemination sessions in agencies, especially central agencies.
3	**Apprise on contribution for project 108 in GMC – Chair of Endowment Committee & SS** The Commission was apprised of the proposal to contribute towards project 108 Stupa in GMC. It was reported that the Endowment Fund had accrued interest amounting to 0.408 mn. The management meeting, held on 18/08/2026, proposed contributing Nu. 0.400 mn, in	The Commission endorsed the contribution of Nu. 0.400 million from the Endowment Fund, along with any additional amount collected through voluntary staff contributions, towards Project 108 in GMC.

	line with the directive of the 28th Commission Meeting to avoid use of government resources and involuntary contributions from the staff. The Commission was further apprised that, while the contribution from the Endowment Fund is considered a contribution on behalf of the staff, some had expressed interest in making separate voluntary contributions in their individual capacity, particularly those who did not have an opportunity to contribute earlier. Accordingly, voluntary staff contributions were proposed in addition to the contribution from the Endowment Fund.	The Commission agreed to the proposal to visit the Project office on Friday to hand over the contribution.
4	**Apprise on HR matters – SS** The following was apprised to the Commission: i) The Royal Civil Service Commission had approved the proposal for the assessment of the P1M category for the FY 2025-26. ii) It was apprised that the appeal period for the moderation exercise will close on 24 August 2026. In line with the Policy & Procedures for Moderation Exercise, it was proposed that an independent committee be constituted to review the appeals and submit the report to the Chairperson. iii) The Commission was apprised of the government vehicle accident involving an ACC official, which had earlier been deliberated during the 3rd and 4th HRC meetings. The police report received on 07/08/2026 and the written statement of the official concerned were reviewed. The Commission noted the HRC's recommendation that, pursuant to Section 19.3.6 of the BCSR, the authority to impose penalties on officials at the EX1–EX3/ES1–ES3 levels rests with the RCSC. However, given that the incident was not related to the discharge of official duties or professional misconduct, the Commission discussed whether the matter really warranted referral to the RCSC or, if dealt with internally by the ACC, how the matter should be addressed and what appropriate action should be taken. iv) The changes in the leadership of ACRD and CMD of DoPS were apprised.	The Commission noted updates on i) and iv). ii) The Commission endorsed the formation of an Independent Appeal Review Committee and nominated the following officials as the members: a) Mr. Tashi Jamtsho, Specialist; b) Mr. Tsheten Tshering, Chief ACRD; and c) Ms. Sangay Lhamo, RD Trashigang. iii) The Commission directed the Commissioner in-charge of the HRC to informally seek views and clarification from the RCSC Focal Commissioner about the appropriate dealing of such matters. Based on the clarification, the Commission will determine the appropriate course of action.
5	**Present Software Requirements Specification (SRS) for the AD enhancement – ADMD, DoPE** The SRS for the enhancement of the Asset Declaration (AD) System aims to make the system more integrated and user-friendly, ensure data accuracy, reduce manual data entry, and strengthen verification and monitoring. The *details are as provided in Annexure 2.*	The Commission endorsed the proposed SRS and emphasized that the upgraded system should reduce the burden on declarants. In particular, information on the value/cost of properties such as land, buildings and vehicles, should be pre-populated or retrieved directly from the relevant databases

	The Commission noted that while the AD System is integrated with databases of other agencies, it is not integrated with the ACC's own CIMS. Further integration with relevant systems, including ePEMS, eSAKOR, RSEBL, financial institutions and others, was also discussed. The SRS identifies these and other external systems for possible API integration.	or authoritative sources, rather than making the individual declarants enter manually. **ADMD was directed to ensure that the enhanced AD System is ready before the next declaration period.** In the meantime, ADMD was directed to prepare a circular to the declarants informing them of the ongoing enhancement and the ACC's efforts to make the process more user-friendly and less time-consuming and burdensome through pre-population of data from government data bases. This will also help to signal to declarants that the ACC has access to relevant information for verification. Further, wherever additional system/API integration is required, the ADMD was directed to initiate engagement of the relevant agencies/data custodians, including RSEBL and MoF.
6	**Present annual OIP assessment report of STCBL – PD, DoPE** The Annual OIP assessment of STCBL pertaining to Case 36/2023-24 on 'Embezzlement of Public Property by the Sales Executive' was apprised. The assessment reported an overall 95% compliance rate, with nine of the ten recommendations fully implemented and one partially implemented. The recommendations relating to credit policy and physical verification were fully implemented, while the recommendation on clearing the Debtor Suspense Account remained partially implemented. *The details are as provided in Annexure 3.* In view of the substantial compliance achieved, PD recommended closure of the follow-up actions on the OIP, with recovery of the remaining balance to continue separately through the routine recovery process.	The Commission endorsed the proposal and decided to close the follow-up actions on the OIP with STCBL. Directed to include such positive outcomes resulting from the ACC's interventions in the Annual Report.
7	**Apprise on the visit to Dzongkhags & Schools – ED, DoPE** The Commission was apprised of the Chairperson's visits from 9–14 August 2026 to four Dzongkhag Administrations (Dagana, Tsirang, Trongsa and Zhemgang), and four schools (Tsangkha MSS, Tsirangtoe CS, Phobjikha CS and Tshangkha CS) covering a total of 1,724 participants.	ED was directed to review and submit recommendations to the Commission on club coordinators' requests for capacity building and appropriate recognition.

8	**Present OECD's Public Integrity Index (PII) – PPD** The preliminary assessment of data sources for four dimensions of the PII, covering 13 themes, 43 indicators and 336 questions, along with the relevant data providing agencies, were presented. It was noted that the ACC would be the primary data provider, accounting for 115 responses across all four dimensions. The preliminary assessment also identified a possible data gap of about 13%. *The details are as provided in Annexure 4.* Against the proposal to constitute a Technical Working Group, the Commission discussed directly engaging the Heads of relevant Agencies, followed by coordination with their respective PPDs focals for timely completion of the questionnaire, with regular follow-ups by the ACC.	The Commission decided to first apprise the Hon'ble Prime Minister on the proposed participation in the OECD PII, following which an Expression of Interest (EoI) can be submitted to the OECD. PPD was directed to prepare a one-page brief for submission to the HPM and thereafter plan meetings and presentations with the Heads of relevant Agencies. Further, where NIA dissemination has not yet been conducted for the identified agencies, the Chairperson will introduce the PII during those sessions.
9	**Apprise on Terms of Reference for development of ICT Roadmap – PPD** The Commission noted that the proposed scope broadly covered the key requirements, including assessment of the existing ICT environment, digital transformation, enterprise architecture, ICT and data governance, cybersecurity, emerging technologies, and an implementation plan. On the proposed engagement of a national consultant through open tendering, the Commission expressed serious doubts on the availability and capability of local firms to undertake an assignment of this nature. Considering engagement of TOPPAN Ecquaria Pte. Ltd. for the Justice Sector Blueprint and related project proposal, the Commission emphasized that the selected consultant's quality should be comparable in experience and quality to the work undertaken by TOPPAN Ecquaria Pte. Ltd.	The Commission endorsed the draft ToR but directed that knowledge management should also be specifically incorporated in the scope of work. PPD was directed to first assess the local market to determine availability of competent national consultants with relevant experience, instead of proceeding directly with an open tender. The appropriate procurement approach should be determined based on the market assessment.
10	**Present proposal for the 'Meet with Editors' – PPD** Reviewed the proposal to meet the Chief Editors of the media houses, including the EDs of JAB and BMF. The Commission emphasized that the engagement should clarify the ACC's mandate and functioning and address prevailing misconceptions about its operations.	PPD was directed to schedule the meeting after 9 September 2026 and revise the programme to include a presentation covering the broader contexts, like 13th FYP, relevant legal framework, Bhutan's international standing, and the role of the media in supporting anti-corruption efforts, among others. The programme should also provide adequate space to hear the perspectives of the media representatives, followed by an open discussion.
11	**Invitation for '*European Conference on Measuring Anti-Corruption Agency Effectiveness*' to be held from 16 – 18 September 2026 in Rome, Italy – PPD**	The Commission decided to nominate Rinchen Namgay to

	The Commission was apprised of the invitation extended to Rinchen Namgay, PPD, to attend the European Conference on Measuring Anti-Corruption Agency Effectiveness in Rome, Italy, jointly organized by IACA and ANAC, with participation costs covered by the organizers. The invitation was extended in recognition of his experience and institutional knowledge from previous IACA expert meetings. The Commission noted that Rinchen had also been nominated to accompany the Chairperson to the Global Expert Meeting on Intelligent Tools for Anti-Corruption Agency Effectiveness in Ljubljana, Slovenia, from 2–3 September 2026. Given the back-to-back engagements, limited time for visa processing for an alternative nominee to Slovenia, and the specific invitation extended to Rinchen for the Rome conference, the Commission considered changing the earlier nomination not feasible.	attend the conference in Rome, as specifically invited by IACA.
12	**Invitation to apply for the '*Strong Nations for Asia Programme 2026*' to be held in segments between October – December 2026, received from Chandler Academy of Governance – PPD** The Commission was apprised of the invitation to apply for the inaugural Strong Nations for Asia Programme 2026, which will be conducted in three segments between October and December 2026, comprising in-person programmes in Viet Nam and Singapore and an online segment. Considering the eligibility criteria, which require applicants to hold a senior leadership or management role, such as Deputy Director or equivalent, the Commission discussed nominating an official at the P1 level or above.	The Commission nominated Wangay Dorji, Director of DoPS, to apply for the programme and the scholarship offered by the Chandler Academy of Governance.

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**